Story Starter

One copy-and-paste prompt that helps you start a story when the page is blank - it gives you openings, characters and a first scene to choose from, then stops so the story stays yours.

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Free student notes - Writing & English set

What this note is: a single shortcut, on its own, so you can save it, print it and use it in seconds. Copy the prompt on page 2 into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Muse or any other AI chat, add your idea, and pick the beginning you like best.

The copy-and-paste prompt

Story Starter Works in: ChatGPT - Claude - Gemini - Muse

> Help me START a story. My idea is: [YOUR IDEA, OR WRITE "NO IDEA YET"]. My level is [CLASS / AGE]. Follow these rules strictly:
> 1. Give me 3 different story openings, each only 2-3 sentences long. Make each one different: one exciting, one mysterious, one funny.
> 2. For my favourite opening, suggest 2 main characters with names, ages and one interesting detail each.
> 3. Give me a simple plan with 4 parts: the beginning, the problem, the exciting middle, and the ending I should aim for - in one short line each. Do NOT write the ending for me.
> 4. Write ONLY the first paragraph of the story, then stop and write: "Now it is your turn - continue from here."
> 5. Do NOT write the whole story for me. I want to write it myself.
> 6. Use words suitable for my level, and keep every idea original - no copying from famous books or films.
> Start with the 3 openings now.

Fill the brackets: replace [YOUR IDEA] with even a few words, for example "a boy who finds a talking parrot", or write "no idea yet" and the AI will suggest ideas first. Replace [CLASS / AGE] with your class, for example "Class 7".

How to use your starter

1. **Paste the prompt** into any AI chat and press send. You will get 3 openings.
2. **Choose one - or mix them.** You can take the exciting opening and the funny character. It is your story.
3. **Change the details.** Rename the characters, change the place, add your village, school or a person you know. Your own details make a story feel real.
4. **Read the 4-part plan.** It tells you where the story is going, so you do not get stuck in the middle.
5. **Continue from the first paragraph in your own words.** Write a little every day if the story is long.
6. **Stuck later? Ask for a hint, not a paragraph.** Type: "Give me 3 ideas for what could happen next - I will choose and write it myself."

> **Why the AI stops after one paragraph:** starting is the hardest part of writing. Once a story has a beginning, characters and a plan, the rest is much easier - and every sentence after the first paragraph is practice that makes you a better writer.

What it looks like in practice

Idea: "a girl who finds an old key", Class 6. This is the kind of reply you will see:

AI - Opening 1 (exciting): The key was still warm when Zara pulled it out of the river mud - and somewhere under the water, something clicked, like a door unlocking.

AI - Opening 2 (mysterious): Nobody in the house used the small door in the back wall. Nobody even talked about it. But on Tuesday, Zara found a key that fitted it exactly.

AI - Opening 3 (funny): Zara only wanted to unlock her bicycle. Instead, the old key unlocked her neighbour's gate, a lunch box, and a very grumpy goat's pen.

You: I like opening 2.

AI: Good choice. Here are your characters and plan, and the first paragraph... Now it is your turn - continue from here.

Change the kind of story

Add one of these short lines under the main prompt to change the story:

Add this line	What changes
Make it a story set in my village in Pakistan.	Places, names and daily life will feel close to your own world.
Make it science fiction, set 100 years in the future.	Robots, space and future inventions enter the story.
I need a short story for my English exam, about 150 words in total.	The plan shrinks to fit a short exam answer.
Give the openings in simple English - I am still learning.	Shorter sentences and easier words throughout.
The story must teach a lesson about honesty.	The plan builds towards a clear moral at the end.

Use it honestly. A story starter is a beginning, not a finished homework answer. If your teacher set story writing as homework or an exam task, the writing must be yours - handing in a story the AI wrote is not your work.

Make it yours. Change names, places and details, and write the story in your own words. Your teacher knows your English level - a story far above it will stand out at once.

More shortcuts in this set: Essay Outline Builder - Correct My English - Grammar Doctor - Vocabulary Builder - English Speaking Partner - and many more free notes on the website.